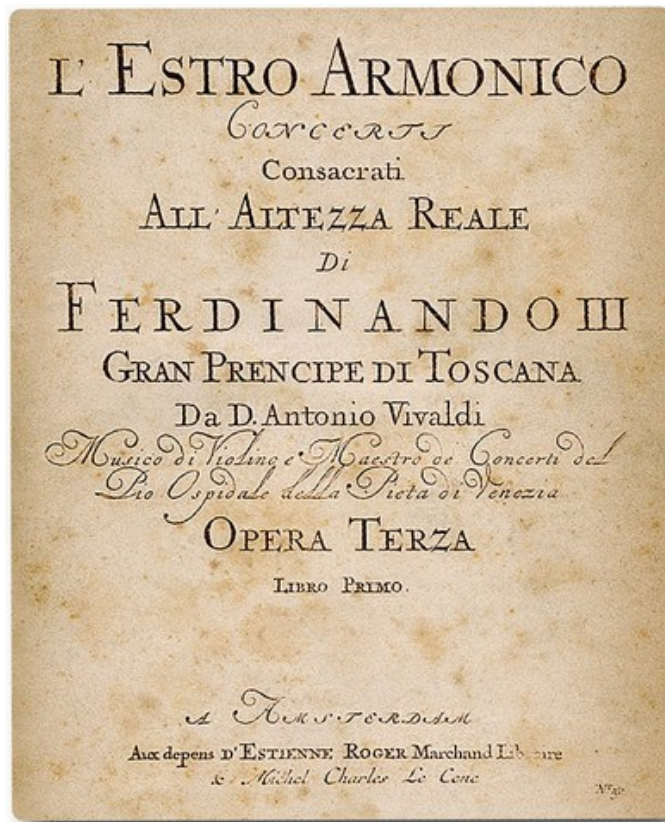




L'ESTRO ARMONICO

The title page of Vivaldi's *Harmonic Inspiration*, published in 1711, shows a dedication to Ferdinand, Grand Prince of Tuscany, a great patron of the arts, and of music in particular. Ferdinand's villa at Poggio a Caiano near Florence was the venue for many musical performances.

A late move to Vienna

By this time, Vivaldi's music had in any case passed the peak of its popularity in Italy and in 1740 he moved to Vienna, hoping to win further patronage from the emperor Charles VI (the two had first met in 1728 and Charles—an accomplished amateur musician—had treated him generously). However, soon after